



Sam Altman

If you have been on the internet anytime this year, you would have heard about ChatGPT. The generative AI model, developed by OpenAI has been creating news across the world. However, in November, it was OpenAI's CEO, Sam Altman who took the limelight. First, by being fired as the CEO and then by getting re-hired for the same position. So, to catch you up with the whole Sam Altman saga, here's a quick run down of how things changed at OpenAI over one fine weekend in November.

Why OpenAI fired CEO Sam Altman?

The news of the removal of OpenAI's CEO Sam Altman created quite a stir on the internet. Altman, who headed ChatGPT's parent company OpenAI, was fired via a strongly worded letter straight from the board at OpenAI. The removal and replacement were so quick that it left a lot of questions hanging. Why was Altman fired in the first place? The removal of Sam Altman sent shock waves across the tech industry as he was not only the face of OpenAI but was also considered a visionary. With OpenAI and its massive reach with ChatGPT, Altman was rightly called the top guy in the AI world. Then what happened? On the face of it, it seems like there have been some disagreements between the board and Altman.

OpenAI shared this news through their blog post, which read, "Mr Altman's departure follows a deliberative review process by the board, which concluded that he was not consistently candid in his communications with the board, hindering its ability to exercise its responsibilities. The board no longer has confidence in his ability to continue leading OpenAI."

Altman joins Microsoft as AI lead

Well, Sam Altman was quick to join hands with a new company. Altman joined hands with Microsoft now and was supposed to be leading the company's "new advanced AI research team," as confirmed by CEO Satya Nadella himself via an X (formerly Twitter) post. OpenAI co-founder Greg Brockman was also set to join Altman at Microsoft, who was apparently fired for supporting Altman's ways.

In the tweet, CEO Nadella said, "We're extremely excited to share the news that Sam Altman and Greg Brockman, together with colleagues, will be joining Microsoft to lead a new advanced AI research team. We look forward to moving quickly to provide them with the resources needed for their success."

OpenAI employees demand board to resign

After Altman's removal, over 500 out of the 700 employees at OpenAI asked the board to resign. They argued that the process of removal of Altman and

Brockman has undermined their mission as a company and even jeopardised all the work that OpenAI has done so far.

They even showed their disappointment and disapproval over the quick switch of Mira Murati to Emmett Shear. In the letter to the board, they said, "Yet within two days of your initial decision, you again replaced interim CEO Mira Murati against the best interests of the company." Further, they have threatened the Board of Directors at OpenAI to resign. The signatories on the letter said that if the board fails to do so, they will join Altman and Brockman at Microsoft's new AI venture. The letter read, "We, the undersigned, may choose to resign from OpenAI and join the newly announced Microsoft subsidiary run by Sam Altman and Greg Brockman. Microsoft has assured us that there are positions for all OpenAI employees at this new subsidiary should we choose to join. We will take this step imminently unless all current board members resign, and the board appoints two new lead independent directors, such as Bret Taylor and Will Hurd, and reinstates Sam Altman and Greg Brockman."

Sam Altman and Greg Brockman are back!

Within just five days of firing him, on 22 November, Sam Altman was brought back as the CEO of OpenAI. Greg Brockman will join him too. Not only have they been re-appointed, but the board is seeing a change too. Taking to X (formerly Twitter) OpenAI said, "We have reached an agreement in principle for Sam Altman to return to OpenAI as CEO with a new initial board of Bret Taylor (Chair), Larry Summers, and Adam D'Angelo." The company further added, "We are collaborating to figure out the details. Thank you so much for your patience through this."

On this, Microsoft CEO Satya Nadella, who had welcomed the two at Microsoft said, "We are encouraged by the changes to the OpenAI board. We believe this is the first essential step on a path to more stable, well-informed, and effective governance." **d**